## CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 11: **Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

**Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes** Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

**General Instructions:**

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

## SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

*Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.*

**1.** Which is a correct sentence containing a relative clause about Keller? 1

**(a)** Keller who deaf and blind became.
**(b)** Keller whom became deaf a leader.
**(c)** Keller, which was deaf, a leader.
**(d)** Keller, who was deaf and blind, became a leader.

**2.** The final stanza's shift to 'the world' broadens the poem from: 1

**(a)** joy to sorrow
**(b)** English to Hindi
**(c)** personal admiration to universal inspiration
**(d)** poetry to prose

**3.** Which sentence expresses the poem's value in the context of social inequality? 1

**(a)** People should be judged by their inner worth, not their limits
**(b)** Only the strong deserve respect
**(c)** Inequality is natural
**(d)** Disabled people need pity

**4.** Which option correctly uses 'despite'? 1

**(a)** Despite blind, found light.
**(b)** Despite of her blindness she found light.
**(c)** Despite her blindness, she found light.
**(d)** Despite she was blind, she found light.

**5.** A critic says, 'The poem ignores Keller's struggle.' A fair response is that: 1

**(a)** the poem is about a king
**(b)** the poem has no theme
**(c)** 'In the dark' compresses the struggle into a few words
**(d)** struggle is described in detail

**6.** Which of these best identifies the speaker's stance? 1

**(a)** a stranger bored by the subject **(b)** an admiring observer
**(c)** a rival **(d)** Keller herself

**7.** Which statement about tone and mood is accurate? 1

**(a)** The tone is playful and the mood eerie
**(b)** The tone is reverent and the mood uplifting
**(c)** The tone is sarcastic and the mood gloomy
**(d)** The tone is angry and the mood tense

**8.** Which element contributes most to the poem's feeling of sincerity? 1

**(a)** complex metaphors **(b)** jokes
**(c)** plain words and short lines **(d)** long descriptions

**9.** If the poem were rewritten in the first person ('I, in the dark, found light'), the main change would be: 1

**(a)** nothing changes
**(b)** it becomes a self-description rather than a tribute
**(c)** it becomes a joke
**(d)** it becomes longer

**10.** Which of the following best represents a 'value-based' reading of the poem? 1

**(a)** collecting rare coins
**(b)** travelling abroad
**(c)** respecting people with disabilities and nurturing inner strength
**(d)** learning jazz

## SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

*Answer in about 20–30 words each.*

**11.** How might the poem's message help someone facing discrimination? 2

**12.** Examine the significance of the word 'own' in 'the soul's own mastery'. 2

**13.** What does the poem imply about what truly counts as sight? 2

**14.** Evaluate: 'The poem is simple, but not simplistic.' 2

## SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

*Answer in about 40–60 words each.*

**15.** Evaluate the poet's choice of the word 'mastery' over 'knowledge'. 3

**16.** Convert to reported speech: The poet said, 'She found light in the dark.' 3

**17.** How can the unit's glossing of 'dower' enrich our reading of the final stanza? 3

OR

How does the poem challenge common attitudes towards disability? 3

**18.** Rewrite in the passive voice: 'Hughes wrote the poem as a tribute.' 3

OR

Why might the poet have chosen not to rhyme the poem rigidly? 3

## SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

*Answer in about 100–150 words each.*

**19.** Examine how the poem uses economy of language to deliver a powerful tribute. 5

OR

Compare the speaker's stance in this poem with that of a poet praising a place or a season; what is distinctive about praising a person's character? 5

**20.** 'To see is not always to have vision.' Discuss with reference to the poem. 5

OR

Write a dialogue between two students discussing whether a short poem can be as effective as a long one. 5

## END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks